Ryde Belize: Legal Drafts v2, Covering Note

Prepared 4 October 2026 · For Ian Popper and Norma Adelita Popper, Ryde Tech (BCCAR No. 000059715)

What these are

Complete rewrites of the eleven customer-facing documents in the legal-review pack, brought up to date with what Ryde is now: a Belize-wide taxi and rentals marketplace, with no commission on rides.

These are drafts, not legal advice. I am an AI drafting assistant, not an attorney admitted in Belize. I have written them to a careful standard, but the Belize attorney must review and sign off before Ryde takes money from the public. Every point I could not verify is marked **[ATTORNEY TO CONFIRM]** in the text, and the same points are collected in the Open Points list below.

The vision, as the documents now state it

> Ryde takes nothing from taxi drivers and adds nothing to riders' fares. Ryde earns from rental shops, and from honest partnerships, not from people who are working hard to make a living.

That promise appears in the Terms, the Driver Agreement, About Ryde, and the Taxis page. It is written as a **commitment with a stated exception process**: if Ryde ever changes this, it must give 60 days' written notice and a driver may leave without penalty. This is deliberate. A promise with no way out is a trap for you; a promise that can change in secret is a trap for them.

What changed

Doc	Change
01 Terms of Service	Belize-wide; taxis and rentals as separate products; BZD-first pricing; card payments through Belize Bank when live; fair limitation of liability; dispute clause
02 Privacy Policy	Names every processor; adds notifications, trip routes, error reports, partner document uploads and the Cloudflare AI reading; retention table; cross-border transfer; ledger-versus-deletion explained
03 Refunds and Cancellations	Adds rides, reservation fee when card payment goes live, and a plain refund process
04A Driver Agreement	**New.** Taxi drivers: permit, PSV licence, passenger insurance, no commission, independent status
04B Shop Agreement	Replaces the cart-shop-only agreement. Rentals only; 15% commission; deposits; sponsored listings placeholder
05–07, 08–09	Country-wide wording; claims narrowed so each one is true and provable
10 Contact	Unchanged facts, plus Data Protection contact line
11 Laws relied on	Expanded, with verification status for each item

Decisions I need from you (they change the text)

1. **Card fees on taxi fares.** When a rider pays a taxi fare by card, Belize Bank will charge Ryde a processing fee. Who bears it? The drafts say **Ryde bears it**, because that is the only way "the driver gets the full fare" stays literally true. If you cannot afford that, the promise must be reworded to "no commission", and a clause added. Tell me which.
2. **Cancellation and no-show fee**: one day's rate each. Keep, or lower for locals?
3. **Reservation fee** equals the 15% commission and is non-refundable. A Belize attorney may say that is a penalty. Decide whether to keep it.
4. **Minimum age**: 18 to rent, 18 to ride alone. Confirm.
5. **Dispute resolution**: courts of Belize (drafted) or arbitration.

Open points for the attorney

The ten questions in the original covering brief stand. In addition I have flagged, in the text:

- Whether the **plate format** (green, D plus four digits) is prescribed. I removed it from the Driver Agreement and refer to "the prescribed identification mark" instead.
- Whether the **golf-cart moratorium** (said to run from 23 October 2024) is still in force. The Shop Agreement now says "if and while in force" and puts the duty on the shop to check.
- Whether Ryde needs a **licence to dispatch taxis or list rentals**.
- **Holding other people's money** once card fares pass through Ryde's account.
- Whether the **Data Protection Act, 2021** requires registration, a data protection officer, or a transfer safeguard for Supabase, Cloudflare, Resend, and Google outside Belize.
- **Cloudflare AI retention terms** for reading licence photos. Not reviewed. Until they are, consider switching that feature off.
- **Trade mark**: "Ryde" was refused by BCCAR as not unique; advice needed.

Claims I removed or narrowed

- "Licensed taxis" is now "taxis whose drivers have shown a current permit, licence and passenger insurance". Ryde checks documents; it does not itself license anyone.
- "Drivers keep their whole fare" is now tied to **fare and tips**, and to decision 1 above.
- "Built for Belize, by Belize" is kept as a brand line, not a factual claim. Please check it with the attorney (item 9).